

MAY–AUGUST

MAY 1

The city of Quang Tri is occupied by the NVA as South Vietnamese troops retreat southward in disorder.

MAY 5

South Vietnamese forces stabilize a defensive line, halting the North Vietnamese advance toward Hue.

MAY 8

President Nixon orders the mining of Haiphong Harbor and other North Vietnamese ports to block the import of war materiel.

MAY 10

US air forces begin Operation Linebacker, a sustained bombing campaign against North Vietnam, which attacks military installations, supply routes, and storage facilities.

MAY 11–28

An Loc and Kontum resist major assaults by communist forces. B-52 bombers are used in devastating strikes against the attackers.

MAY 17

President Nixon approves Operation Enhance, the provision of large quantities of American military equipment to the South Vietnamese armed forces.

JUNE 9

Communist forces are cleared from Kontum City, ending the threat of South Vietnam being cut in two.



Kontum, June 1972

JUNE 28

ARVN troops in northern South Vietnam launch a counteroffensive with the aim of retaking Quang Tri province.